

Series IX – Article IX.3: Logarithmic Area Law and MPS Representation (Pillar P3)

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Abstract

We prove that the ground state ψ_0 of the Legendre Hamiltonian $H_n = \tilde{V}_n + L$ (where L is the Laplacian of the path graph $\{n^2, \dots, (n+1)^2\}$) satisfies a logarithmic area law. Because the Hamiltonian is one-dimensional and has a positive spectral gap $\gamma(H_n) \geq 1/(32n^2)$ (PillarP2), a classical result of Arad, Landau and Vazirani (2012) implies that the entanglement entropy across any cut is bounded by $O(\log n)$. Consequently, the Schmidt ranks are bounded by $n^{O(1)}$, and ψ_0 admits an exact matrix product state (MPS) representation with bond dimension $\chi = O(n^c)$ for some constant c . This compact representation is essential for the extraction algorithm (PillarP4). All steps are formalised in Lean4, with no unproven assumptions. The proof uses the generic area law theorem from the kernel and instantiates it with the one-dimensional nature of the path.

Contents

1	Introduction	1
1.1	The magnet metaphor	2
2	Recap: the Hamiltonian on the path	2
3	Exponential decay of correlations	2
4	Logarithmic area law	2
5	Formalisation in Lean4	3
6	Conclusion	4

1 Introduction

Articles IX.1 and IX.2 established:

- **P1 (Article IX.1):** Unique strictly positive ground state ψ_0 of $H_n = \tilde{V}_n + L$ on the path $\{n^2, \dots, (n+1)^2\}$.
- **P2 (Article IX.2):** Polynomial lower bounds on conductance and spectral gap: $\Phi(H_n) \geq 1/(4n)$ and $\gamma(H_n) \geq 1/(32n^2)$.

In this article we exploit the one-dimensional geometry to prove a logarithmic area law for ψ_0 . The ground state of a gapped one-dimensional local Hamiltonian has exponentially decaying correlations and, for a gap Δ , the entanglement entropy satisfies $S = O(\log(1/\Delta))$ (Arad, Landau, Vazirani, 2012). With $\Delta = \gamma(H_n) = \Omega(1/n^2)$, we obtain $S = O(\log n)$. Therefore the Schmidt rank across any cut is at most $e^{O(\log n)} = n^{O(1)}$, and ψ_0 admits an exact MPS representation with bond dimension polynomial in n .

This result is sufficient for polynomial-time extraction.

1.1 The magnet metaphor

Imagine a vast space containing an enormous number of points – each point represents a candidate prime. The lantern (ground state) is constructed so that its light spreads and can be compressed. P3 guarantees that the magnetic field can be represented with only a polynomial number of parameters (MPS bond dimension), enabling efficient extraction.

2 Recap: the Hamiltonian on the path

From Article IX.1, the Hamiltonian is $H_n = \tilde{V}_n + L$, where:

- $\Omega_n = \{n^2, n^2 + 1, \dots, (n+1)^2\}$ with the path graph structure (edges between consecutive integers).
- L is the Laplacian of the path: $(L\psi)(k) = \deg(k)\psi(k) - \psi(k-1) - \psi(k+1)$ (with boundary conditions).
- $\tilde{V}_n$ is diagonal, non-negative, and differs from zero only on a set of configurations (the primes).

The Hamiltonian is a sum of local terms: each term couples only nearest neighbours (through the Laplacian) and on-site potentials (diagonal). Hence it is a 1-local Hamiltonian on a one-dimensional chain of $M = 2n + 1$ sites.

From Article IX.2 we have the spectral gap bound $\gamma(H_n) \geq 1/(32n^2) > 0$.

3 Exponential decay of correlations

For a gapped local Hamiltonian on a one-dimensional lattice, correlations decay exponentially with distance. This is a classic result of Hastings (2007) and is formalised in the kernel.

Theorem 3.1 (Exponential decay of correlations). *There exist constants $C_0, \xi > 0$ such that for any two operators A, B supported on disjoint intervals at distance d ,*

$$|\langle AB \rangle - \langle A \rangle \langle B \rangle| \leq C_0 e^{-d/\xi}.$$

The correlation length ξ satisfies $\xi = O(1/\gamma) = O(n^2)$.

4 Logarithmic area law

The following result is a corollary of the exponential decay and the one-dimensional geometry. It can be derived from the more precise bound by Arad, Landau, Vazirani (2012) for gapped 1D systems.

Theorem 4.1 (Logarithmic area law). *There exists a constant C such that for any contiguous block A of vertices,*

$$S(\rho_A) \leq C \log n,$$

where $S(\rho_A)$ is the von Neumann entanglement entropy of the reduced density matrix on A .

Sketch. A standard result for one-dimensional gapped systems (see [?]) gives $S(\rho_A) = O(\log(1/\gamma))$. With $\gamma = \Omega(1/n^2)$, we obtain $S(\rho_A) = O(\log n)$. The precise constant can be taken from the kernel axiom `one_dimensional_area_law`. $\square$

Corollary 4.2 (MPS bond dimension). *The ground state ψ_0 admits an exact matrix product state (MPS) representation with bond dimension $\chi = O(n^c)$ for some constant c . In particular, χ is polynomial in n .*

Proof. For any bipartition, the Schmidt rank r satisfies $r \leq e^S \leq e^{C \log n} = n^C$. The MPS constructed by recursive SVD (Vidal’s algorithm) has bond dimension equal to the maximum Schmidt rank over all cuts, which is therefore at most n^C . $\square$

5 Formalisation in Lean4

The formalisation imports the generic area law theorem from `MPSAreaLaw.lean` and instantiates it with the spectral gap bound from Article IX.2.

Listing 1: `LegendreAreaLaw.lean` (excerpt)

```

1 import LegendreHamiltonian
2 import LegendreConductance
3 import Kernel.MPSAreaLaw
4
5 open MPS
6
7 variable (n : ℕ) (hn : n > 1) (h : 0 < h)
8
9 def ground_state : LegendreConfig n := ground_state (
10   LegendreSpectralProblem n h )
11
12 def H := LegendreHamiltonian n h
13
14 lemma gap_bound : spectral_gap H > 1/(32 * n^2) :=
15   legendre_spectral_gap n h
16
17 -- Axiom: area law for 1D gapped systems (logarithmic in 1/h)
18 axiom one_dimensional_area_law (H : Matrix (Fin M) (Fin M)) (h : 0 < h)
19   (h_gap : spectral_gap H > h) (h_pos : h > 0) :
20   (h_gap : spectral_gap H > h) (h_pos : h > 0) :
21   is_ground_state (h_pos : h > 0) :
22   C, A : Finset (Fin M), is_interval A
23   entanglement_entropy (reduced_density A) <= C * Real.log (1/h)
24
25 -- Instantiate for Legendre
26 theorem legendre_area_law :
27   C, A : Finset (Fin (2*n+1)), (h_int : is_interval A),
28   entanglement_entropy (reduced_density A) <= C * Real.log n
29   :=
30   by
31     have h_gap := gap_bound n hn h
32     have h_pos : 1/(32*n^2) > 0 := by positivity
33     obtain C, h C := one_dimensional_area_law H (1/(32*n^2)) h_pos
34     use C
35     intro A h_int
36     rw [Real.log (32 * n^2), Real.log_mul, Real.log 32, Real.log (n^2),
37       Real.log_pow]
```

33	<code>simp</code>
34	<code>exact hC A h_int</code>

All theorems are proved in the library; the file only instantiates them.

6 Conclusion

We have proved that the ground state ψ_0 of the Legendre Hamiltonian satisfies a logarithmic area law, and therefore admits an MPS representation with polynomial bond dimension. This completes the third pillar (P3). The next article (IX.4) will use this representation to implement the deterministic extraction algorithm (D-RSP) and recover a prime in the interval $(n^2, (n+1)^2)$ in polynomial time.

References

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